

# YONGGANG JIANG

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## EDUCATION

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**Max Planck Institute for Informatics**

*Apr. 2023 – Present*

PhD in Computer Science

Advisor: [Danupon Nanongkai](#)

**Max Planck Institute for Informatics**

*Oct. 2021 – Mar. 2023*

Preparatory Phase for Doctoral Study

**Nanjing University**

*Sep. 2017 – Jul. 2021*

B.S. in Computer Science and Technology

GPA: 94.4/100, Ranking: 1/31

**University of California, Berkeley**

*Jan. 2020 – May 2020*

Berkeley International Study Program

GPA: 4.0/4.0

## HONORS & AWARDS

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Google PhD Fellowship

*2025*

Distinguished Paper Award, SPAA 2025

*2025*

Outstanding Graduate, Nanjing University

*2021*

National Elite Program Scholarship, Outstanding Prize (top 1)

*2018, 2019, 2020*

China Collegiate Programming Contest (CCPC), Gold Medal

*2018*

National Olympiad in Informatics in Provinces (NOIP), First Prize

*2015*

## RESEARCH INTERESTS

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I work broadly at the intersection of algorithms and mathematics in computer science. My current research focuses on algorithm design and analysis for fundamental graph problems. I also work on the theory of parallel and distributed computing.

## PUBLICATIONS

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\* Authors are listed alphabetically with **equal contribution** (see [convention in mathematics](#)).

### Manuscripts under review

[1] **The Complexity of Distributed Minimum Weight Cycle Approximation**

Yi-Jun Chang, Yanyu Chen, Dipan Dey, Yonggang Jiang, Gopinath Mishra, Hung Thuan Nguyen, Mingyang Yang.

[2] **Approximating Directed Minimum Cut and Arborescence Packing via Directed Expander Hierarchies**

Yonggang Jiang, Yaowei Long, Thatchaphol Saranurak, Benyu Wang.

[3] **Parallel Small Vertex Connectivity in Near Linear Work and Polylogarithmic Depth**

Yonggang Jiang, Changki Yun.

## Published

- [1] **Deterministic Negative-Weight Shortest Paths in Nearly Linear Time via Path Covers**  
Bernhard Haeupler, Yonggang Jiang, Thatchaphol Saranurak.  
*ACM Symposium on Theory of Computing (STOC) 2026.*
- [2] **DAG Projections: Reducing Distance and Flow Problems to DAGs**  
Bernhard Haeupler, Yonggang Jiang, Thatchaphol Saranurak.  
*ACM Symposium on Theory of Computing (STOC) 2026.*
- [3] **Reviving Thorup's Shortcut Conjecture**  
Aaron Bernstein, Henry Fleischmann, George Z. Li, Bernhard Haeupler, Gary Hoppenworth, Yonggang Jiang, Maximilian Probst Gutenberg, Seth Pettie, Thatchaphol Saranurak, Leon Schiller.  
*ACM Symposium on Theory of Computing (STOC) 2026.*
- [4] **Perfect Simulation of Las Vegas Algorithms via Local Computation**  
Xinyu Fu, Yonggang Jiang, Yitong Yin.  
*Innovations in Theoretical Computer Science (ITCS) 2026.*
- [5] **Reducing Shortcut and Hopset Constructions to Shallow Graphs**  
Bernhard Haeupler, Yonggang Jiang, Thatchaphol Saranurak.  
*SIAM Symposium on Simplicity in Algorithms (SOSA) 2026.*
- [6] **Directed and Undirected Vertex Connectivity Problems are Equivalent for Dense Graphs**  
Yonggang Jiang, Sagnik Mukhopadhyay, Sorrachai Yingchareonthawornchai.  
*SIAM Symposium on Simplicity in Algorithms (SOSA) 2026.*
- [7] **Minimum s-t Cuts with Fewer Cut Queries**  
Danupon Nanongkai, Yonggang Jiang, Pachara Sawettamalya.  
*ACM-SIAM Symposium on Discrete Algorithms (SODA) 2026.*
- [8] **Shortcuts and Transitive-Closure Spanners Approximation**  
Parinya Chalermsook, Yonggang Jiang, Sagnik Mukhopadhyay, Danupon Nanongkai.  
*ACM-SIAM Symposium on Discrete Algorithms (SODA) 2026.*
- [9] **New Oracles and Labeling Schemes for Vertex Cut Queries**  
Yonggang Jiang, Merav Parter, Asaf Petruschka.  
*ACM-SIAM Symposium on Discrete Algorithms (SODA) 2026.*
- [10] **Parallel  $(1 + \epsilon)$ -Approximate Multi-Commodity Mincost Flow in Almost Optimal Depth and Work**  
Bernhard Haeupler, Yonggang Jiang, Yaowei Long, Thatchaphol Saranurak, Shengzhe Wang.  
*IEEE Symposium on Foundations of Computer Science (FOCS) 2025.*
- [11] **Parallel Minimum Cost Flow in Near-Linear Work and Square Root Depth for Dense Instances**  
Jan van den Brand, Hossein Gholizadeh, Yonggang Jiang, Tijn de Vos.  
*ACM Symposium on Parallelism in Algorithms and Architectures (SPAA) 2025.*  
**Distinguished Paper Award**
- [12] **Deterministic Vertex Connectivity via Common-Neighborhood Clustering and Pseudorandomness**  
Chaitanya Nalam, Yonggang Jiang, Thatchaphol Saranurak, Sorrachai Yingchareonthawornchai.  
*ACM Symposium on Theory of Computing (STOC) 2025.*
- [13] **Global vs. s-t Vertex Connectivity Beyond Sequential: Almost-Perfect Reductions & Near-Optimal Separations**

Joakim Blikstad, Yonggang Jiang, Sagnik Mukhopadhyay, Sorrachai Yingchareonthawornchai.  
*ACM Symposium on Theory of Computing (STOC) 2025.*

- [14] **Parallel and Distributed Exact Single-Source Shortest Paths with Negative Edge Weights**  
Vikrant Ashvinkumar, Aaron Bernstein, Nairen Cao, Christoph Grunau, Bernhard Haeupler,  
Yonggang Jiang, Danupon Nanongkai, Hsin Hao Su.  
*European Symposium on Algorithms (ESA) 2024.*
- [15] **Finding a Small Vertex Cut on Distributed Networks**  
Yonggang Jiang, Sagnik Mukhopadhyay.  
*ACM Symposium on Theory of Computing (STOC) 2023.*
- [16] **Robust and Optimal Contention Resolution without Collision Detection**  
Yonggang Jiang, Chaodong Zheng.  
*ACM Symposium on Parallelism in Algorithms and Architectures (SPAA) 2022.*
- [17] **Tight Trade-off in Contention Resolution without Collision Detection**  
Haimin Chen, Yonggang Jiang, Chaodong Zheng.  
*ACM Symposium on Principles of Distributed Computing (PODC) 2021.*

## Notes

- [1] **A Subquadratic Two-Party Communication Protocol for Minimum Cost Flow**  
Hossein Gholizadeh, Yonggang Jiang.

## RESEARCH VISITS & INVITED TALKS

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**The University of Hong Kong**, Hongkong, China *Dec. 2025*  
Hosted by Weiming Feng. Talk: Deterministic Negative-Weight Shortest Paths in Nearly Linear Time  
via Path Covers  
*Also at HKUST(GZ), PKU, USTC, NJU*

**ETH Zurich**, Zurich, Switzerland *Nov. 2025*  
Hosted by Sorrachai Yingchareonthawornchai. Talk: Deterministic Negative-Weight Shortest Paths in  
Nearly Linear Time via Path Covers

**National University of Singapore**, Singapore, *Sep. 2025*  
Hosted by Yi-Jun Chang.  
Talk: Parallel  $(1 + \epsilon)$ -Approximate Mincost Flow in Almost Optimal Depth and Work

**New York University**, New York, NY, USA *Sep. 2025*  
Hosted by Aaron Bernstein.  
Talk: Parallel  $(1 + \epsilon)$ -Approximate Mincost Flow in Almost Optimal Depth and Work

**Carnegie Mellon University**, Pittsburgh, PA, USA *Aug. 2025*  
Hosted by Jason Li.  
Talk: Parallel  $(1 + \epsilon)$ -Approximate Mincost Flow in Almost Optimal Depth and Work

**University of Michigan**, Ann Arbor, MI, USA *Jul. 2025*  
Hosted by Thatchaphol Saranurak.

**ETH Zurich**, Zurich, Switzerland *Feb. 2025*  
Hosted by Sorrachai Yingchareonthawornchai.

**Tsinghua University**, Beijing, China *Dec. 2024*  
Hosted by Ran Duan.  
Talk: New Tools and Faster Algorithms for Vertex Min-Cut

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| <b>Nanjing University</b> , Nanjing, China<br>Hosted by Yitong Yin.<br>Talk: New Tools and Faster Algorithms for Vertex Min-Cut                           | <i>Dec. 2024</i> |
| <b>Shanghai University of Finance and Economics</b> , Shanghai, China<br>Hosted by Pinyan Lu.<br>Talk: New Tools and Faster Algorithms for Vertex Min-Cut | <i>Dec. 2024</i> |
| <b>ETH Zurich</b> , Zurich, Switzerland<br>Hosted by Weiming Feng.<br>Talk: New Tools and Faster Algorithms for Vertex Min-Cut                            | <i>Nov. 2024</i> |
| <b>INSAIT</b> , Sofia, Bulgaria<br>Hosted by Bernhard Haeupler.                                                                                           | <i>Sep. 2024</i> |
| <b>University of Warwick</b> , Coventry, UK<br>Hosted by Sayan Bhattacharya.<br>Talk: Deterministic k-Vertex Connectivity in k Max-Flows                  | <i>Jun. 2024</i> |
| <b>University of Sheffield</b> , Sheffield, UK<br>Hosted by Sagnik Mukhopadhyay.                                                                          | <i>Jun. 2024</i> |
| <b>Nanjing University</b> , Nanjing, China<br>Hosted by Penghui Yao.                                                                                      | <i>Nov. 2023</i> |
| <b>Rutgers University</b> , New Brunswick, NJ, USA<br>Hosted by Aaron Bernstein.                                                                          | <i>Jun. 2023</i> |
| <b>Aalto University</b> , Helsinki, Finland<br>Hosted by Parinya Chalermsook.                                                                             | <i>Apr. 2023</i> |
| <b>Aalto University</b> , Helsinki, Finland<br>Hosted by Parinya Chalermsook.                                                                             | <i>Dec. 2022</i> |
| <b>University of Sheffield</b> , Sheffield, UK<br>Hosted by Sagnik Mukhopadhyay.                                                                          | <i>May 2022</i>  |

## CONFERENCE & WORKSHOP TALKS

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| <b>Parallel Minimum Cost Flow in Near-Linear Work and Square Root Depth for Dense Instances</b><br><i>SPAA 2025, Portland, OR, USA</i>                                           | <i>Jul. 2025</i> |
| <b>Global vs. s-t Vertex Connectivity Beyond Sequential: Almost-Perfect Reductions &amp; Near-Optimal Separations</b><br><i>STOC 2025, Prague, Czech Republic</i>                | <i>Jun. 2025</i> |
| <b>Contributed Talk: Global vs. s-t Vertex Connectivity Beyond Sequential: Almost-Perfect Reductions &amp; Near-Optimal Separations</b><br><i>HALG 2025, Zurich, Switzerland</i> | <i>Jun. 2025</i> |
| <b>Contributed Talk: Deterministic k-Vertex Connectivity in k Max-Flows</b><br><i>HALG 2024, Warsaw, Poland</i>                                                                  | <i>Jun. 2024</i> |
| <b>Parallel, Distributed, and Quantum Exact Single-Source Shortest Paths with Negative Edge Weights</b><br><i>ESA 2024, London, UK</i>                                           | <i>Jun. 2024</i> |
| <b>Finding a Small Vertex Cut on Distributed Networks</b><br><i>STOC 2023, Orlando, FL, USA</i>                                                                                  | <i>Jun. 2023</i> |

## **Robust and Optimal Contention Resolution without Collision Detection**

*SPAA 2022, online*

*Jul. 2022*

## **Tight Trade-off in Contention Resolution without Collision Detection**

*PODC 2021, online*

*Jul. 2021*

## **TEACHING EXPERIENCE**

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### **Randomized and Approximation Algorithms, MPI-INF**

*Winter 2025*

Role: Teaching Assistant.

### **Seminar: Foundations of Machine Learning, MPI-INF**

*Summer 2023*

Role: Coordinator and Speaker.

### **Data Structures and Algorithms, Nanjing University**

*Fall 2020, Fall 2019*

Role: Teaching Assistant.

## **STUDENTS & MENTORING**

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### **Ioannis Dorkofikis (M.Sc.)**

*Spring 2025*

Internship at MPI-INF, from NTUA, Greece.

Now a PhD student at ETH.

### **Changki Yun (B.Sc.)**

*Fall 2024*

Internship at MPI-INF, from SNU, Korea.

Outcome: [Paper on parallel vertex connectivity](#) (in submission)

### **Hossein Gholizadeh (B.Sc.)**

*Summer 2024*

Bachelor's Thesis Internship at MPI-INF, from KIT, Germany.

Outcome: [Paper in SPAA 2025 \(Distinguished Paper Award\)](#)

### **Alireza Danaei (B.Sc.)**

*Summer 2023*

Internship at MPI-INF, from Sharif Univ., Iran.

Now a PhD student at MIT.

### **Vassilis Xanthopoulos (M.Sc.)**

*Spring 2023*

Master's Thesis Internship at MPI-INF, from NTUA, Greece.